

AN OBJECT

The single-stem vase

No object earns its keep in a calm home like the bud vase. It asks for one stem, not a bouquet — which means it asks you to *choose*, and choosing is the whole discipline. A single branch in a narrow vase is not a smaller flower arrangement. It is a different idea: that one thing, given space, says more than many things given none.

Keep two or three on a windowsill, varied in height, and let the garden fill them as it can — a budding twig in March, a single tulip in April, a stem of herb in May. The cost is nothing. The change is weekly. And the surface stays clear, because the vase only ever holds one thing.



"One stem is not less than a bouquet. It is a decision a bouquet lets you avoid."